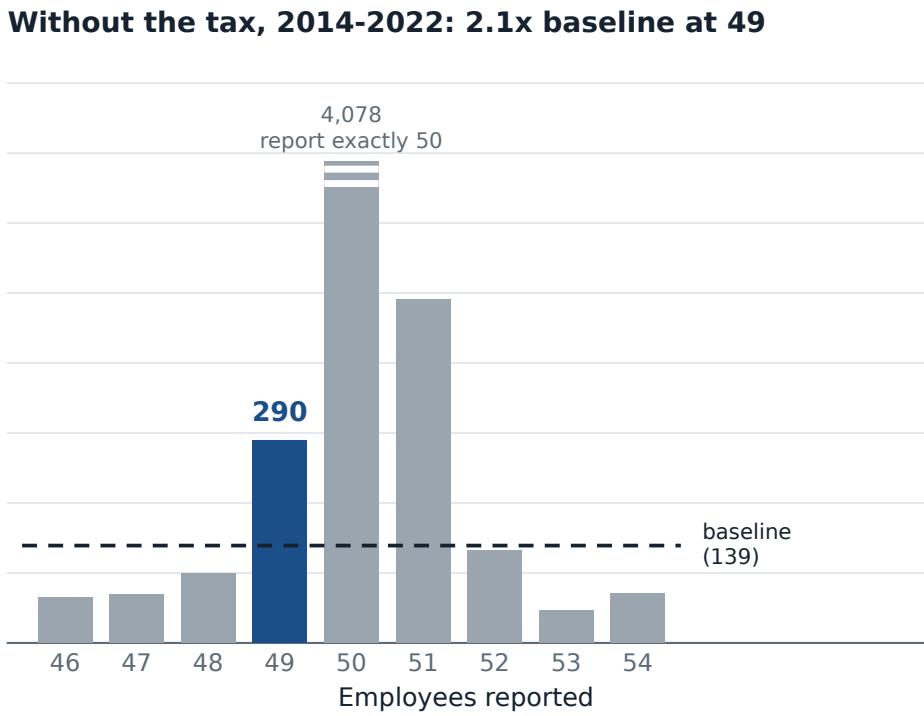
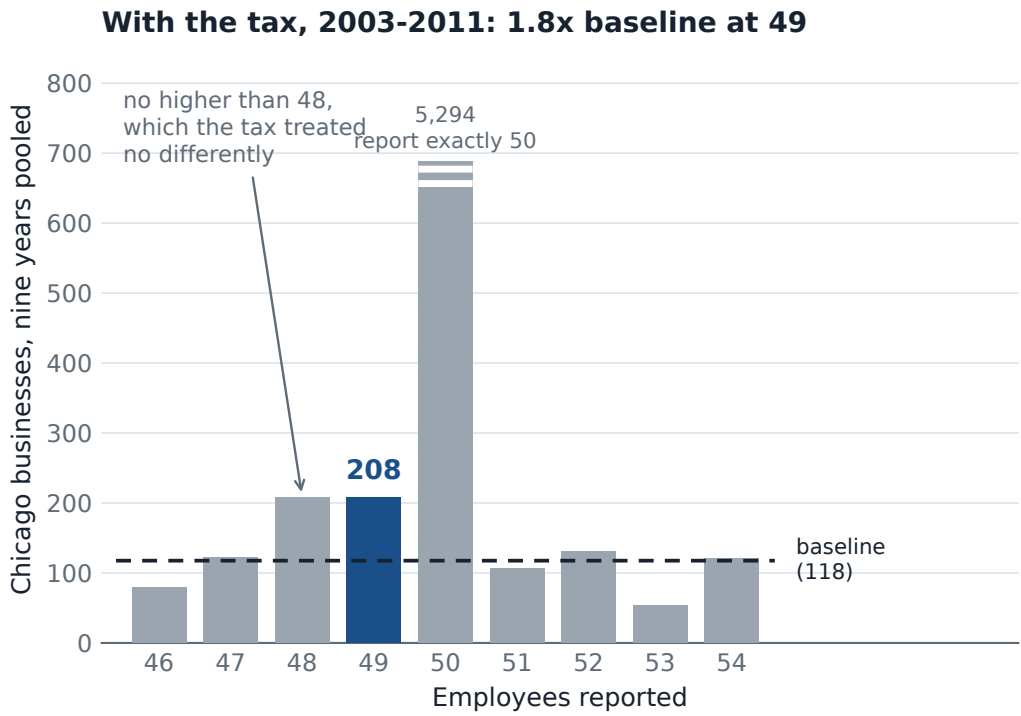


Businesses at 49 were no more numerous while the tax applied than after it was repealed

Chicago businesses at each reported size, pooled over nine years; dashed line is the average of neighbouring sizes



Single-location Chicago businesses reporting their own headcount. The tax applied at 50 or more employees, so 49 was the last untaxed size and avoidance would raise the count there. 208 businesses reported 49 with the tax and 290 without it, over nine years each. Ratios are the count at 49 over the average at neighbouring sizes (46-48 and 51-54; 50 is excluded). Dropping 51 from the baseline gives 1.7 and 3.6; using only 46-48 gives 1.5 and 3.7; only 52-54 gives 2.0 and 3.5. Counts at 51 rise from 2014 in the vendor file for reasons we cannot document, and are left as reported. Size 50 is truncated and excluded from every baseline, because businesses round their own headcount to it; sizes 45 and 55 carry heaps of their own and fall outside the window. Source: Data Axle (Infogroup) historical business files.